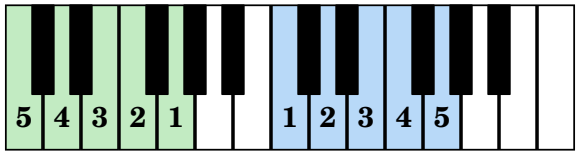
Unit 3

Dotted Quarter Notes

New: The dotted quarter note followed by an eighth: 'long-short'

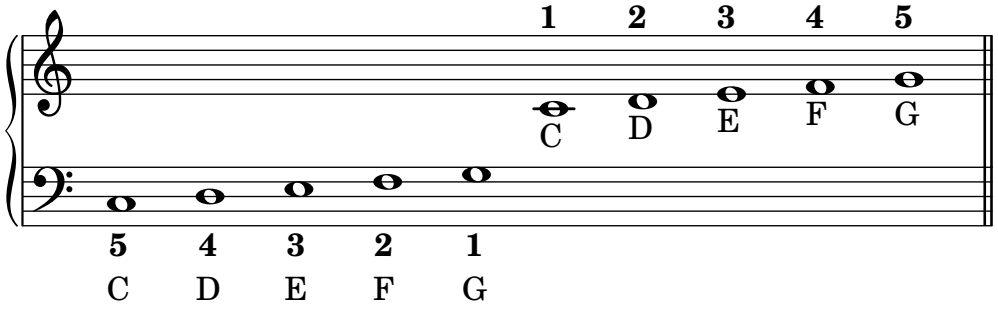
A dot after a note adds half of its value. You already know the dotted half note (3 beats). Now meet the dotted quarter note: one and a half beats, almost always followed by a single eighth note that completes the second beat.



Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The dotted quarter

A quarter note (1 beat) plus its dot (half a beat) makes one and a half beats.

Long-short

A dotted quarter and an eighth together fill two beats. Count '1 and 2 and': the dotted quarter lasts through '1 and 2', and the eighth comes on the second 'and'.

How it sounds

A lilting long-short, like the end of the first line of 'Ode to Joy'.

Reading tips

1. When you scan, count in eighths ('1 and 2 and') and notice that the dotted quarter covers '1 and 2'.

2. Don't shorten the dotted quarter. The eighth comes late, just before the next beat.

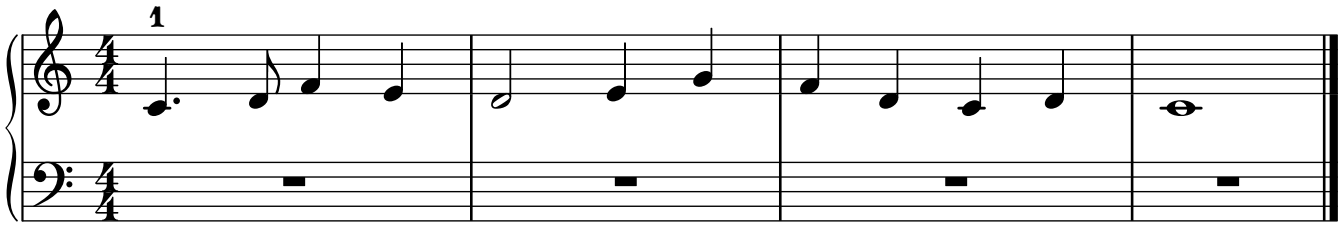
3. A dotted quarter in the middle of a bar crosses a beat. Keep counting through it.

4. Use the metronome, and keep it slow.

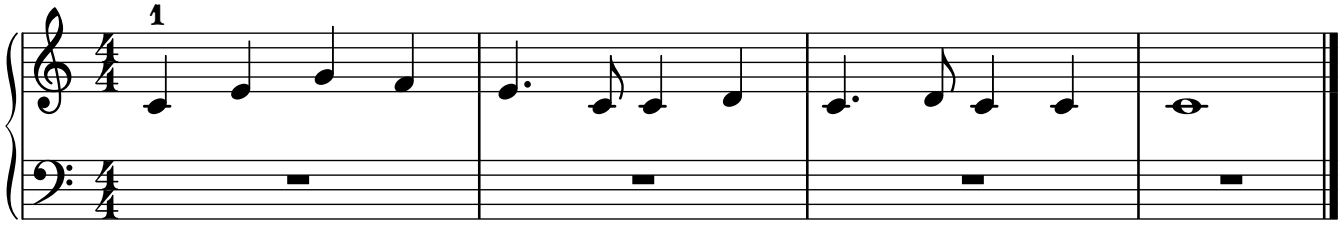
Part A: Dotted rhythms, right hand ♩ = 60

Dotted quarter and eighth patterns in the right hand. Metronome 60.

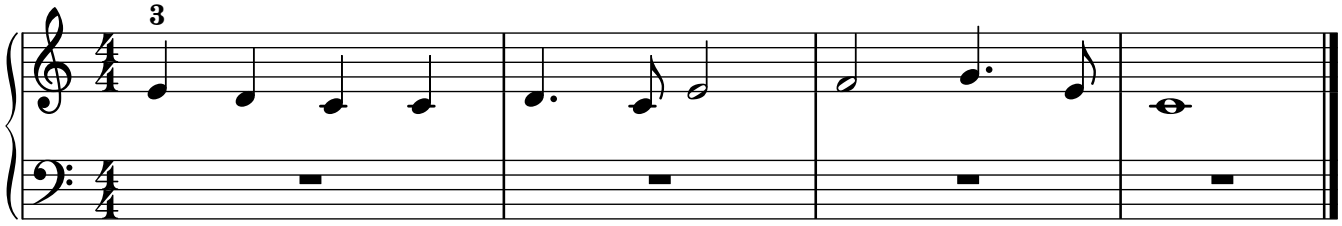
☐ **3.1**



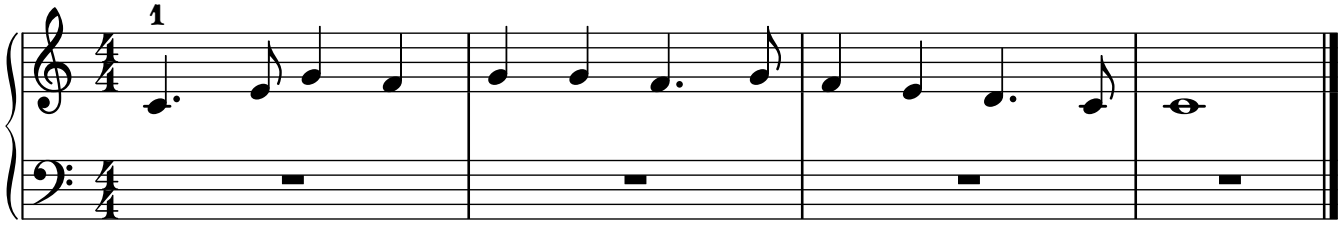
☐ **3.2**



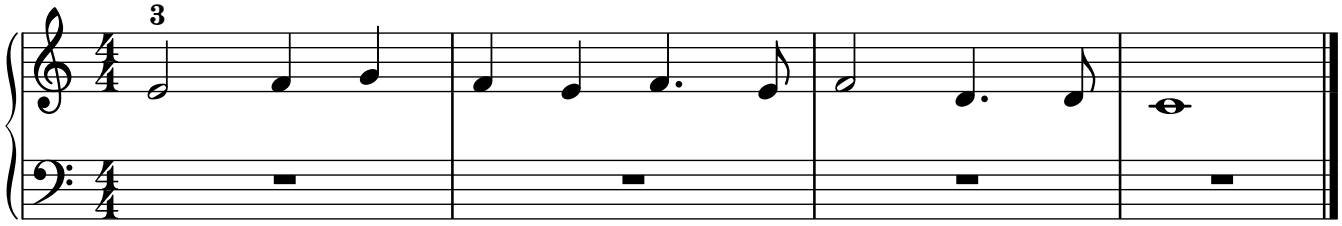
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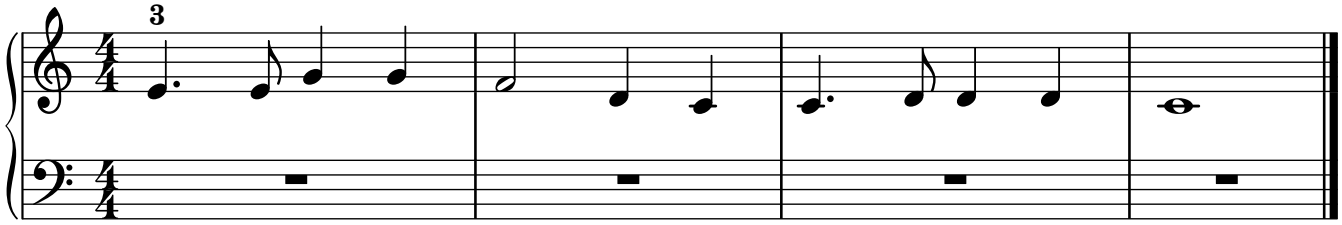
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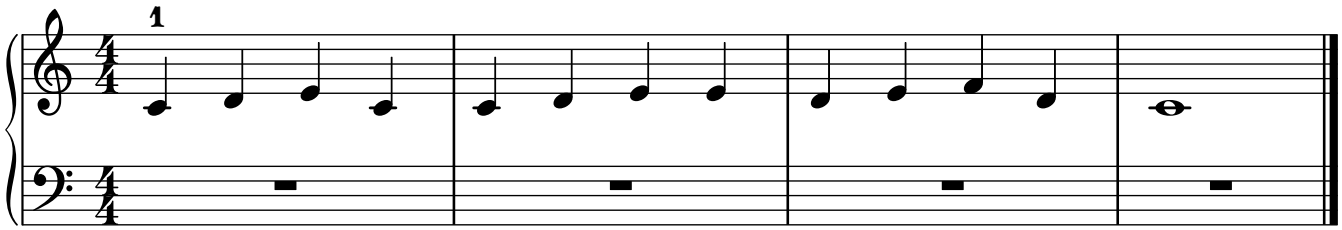
☐ **3.5**



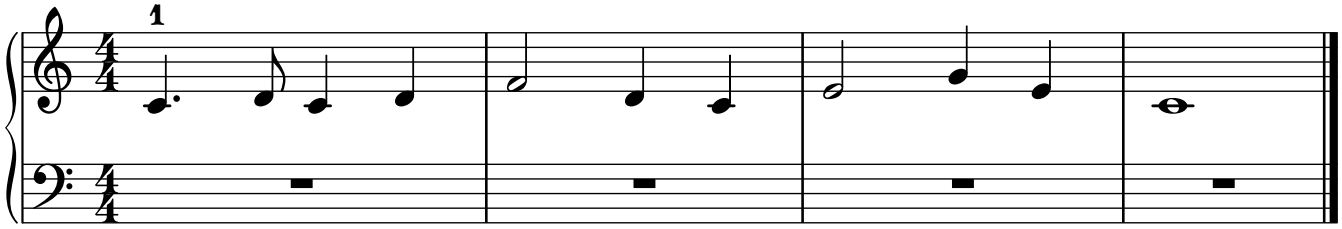
☐ **3.6**



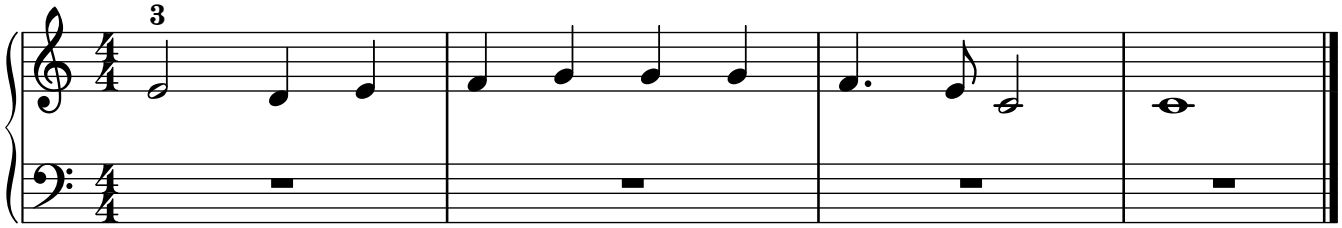
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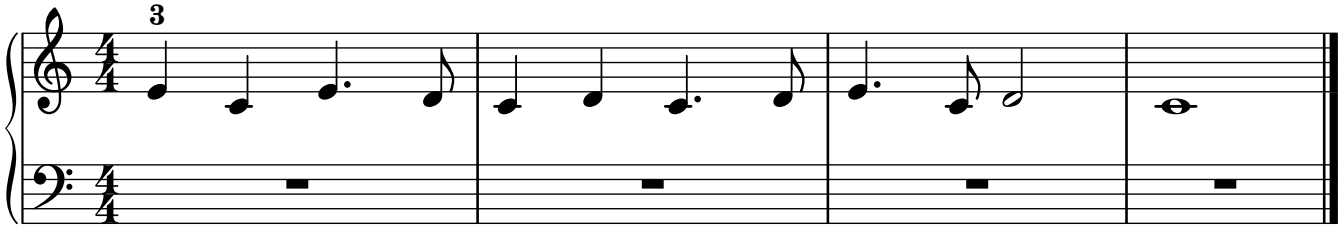
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3.9



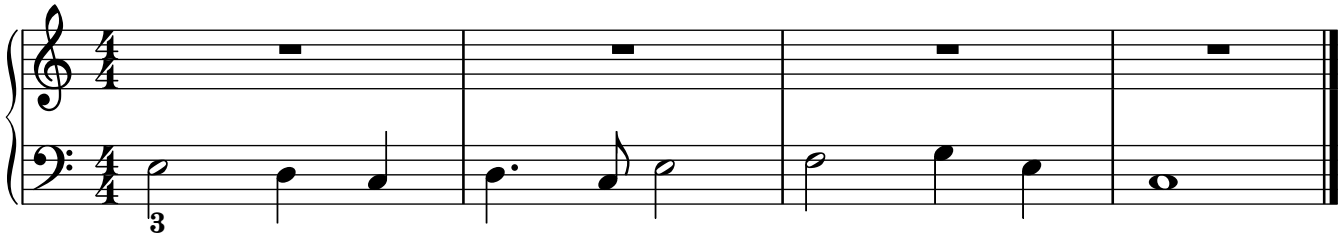
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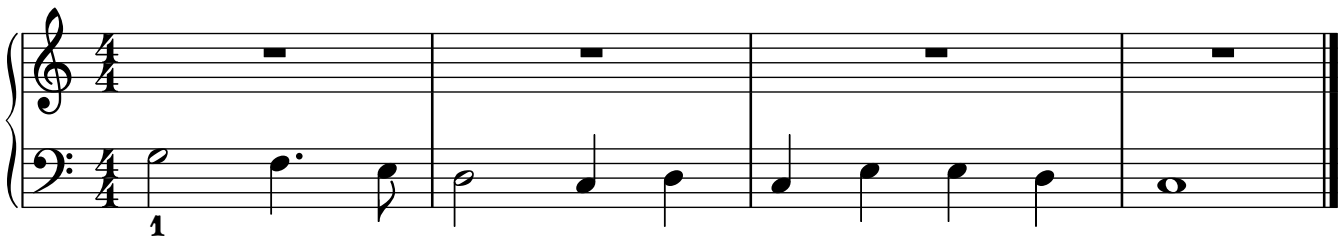
Part B: Dotted rhythms, left hand ♩ = 60

The same rhythms in the left hand.

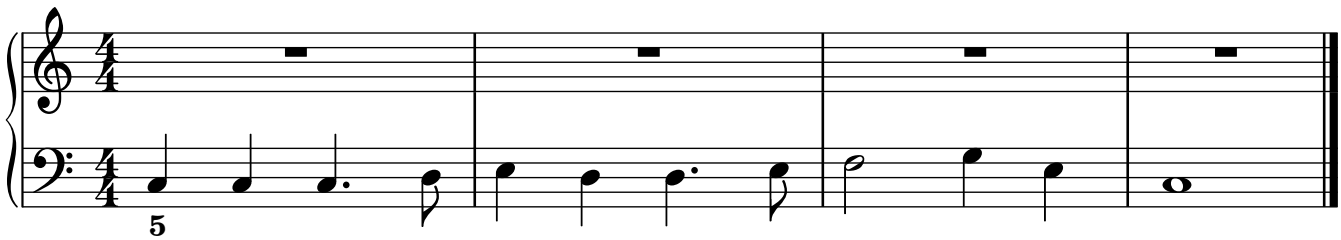
☐ **3.11**



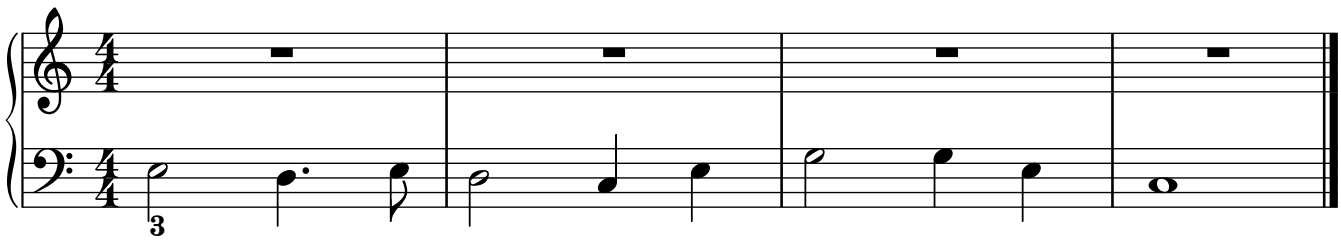
☐ **3.12**



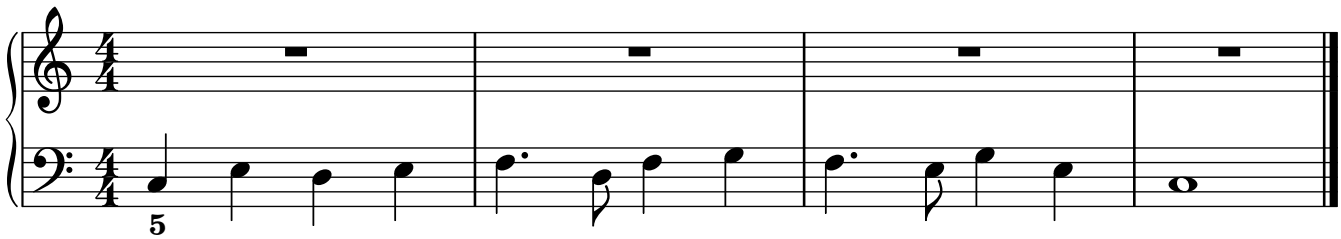
☐ **3.13**



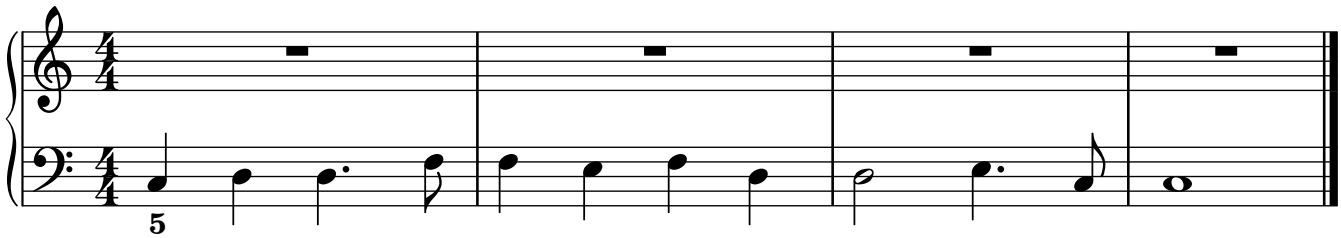
☐ **3.14**



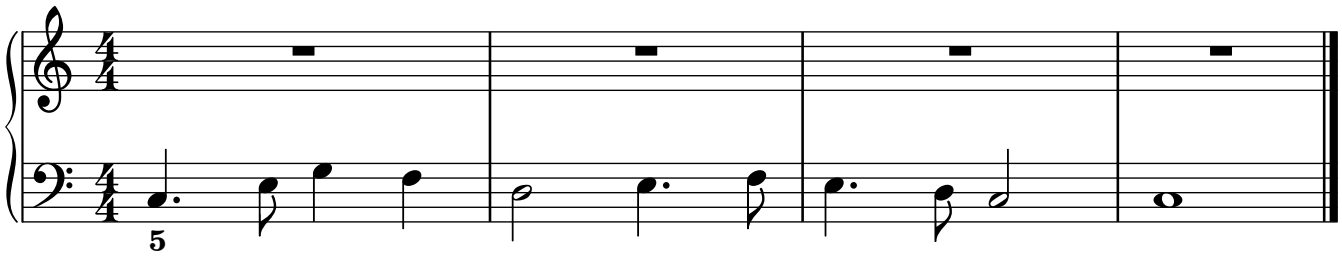
☐ **3.15**



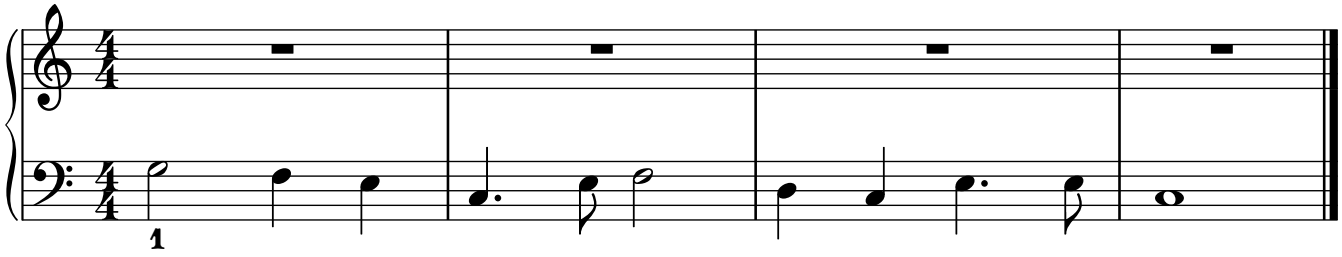
☐ **3.16**



3.17



3.18
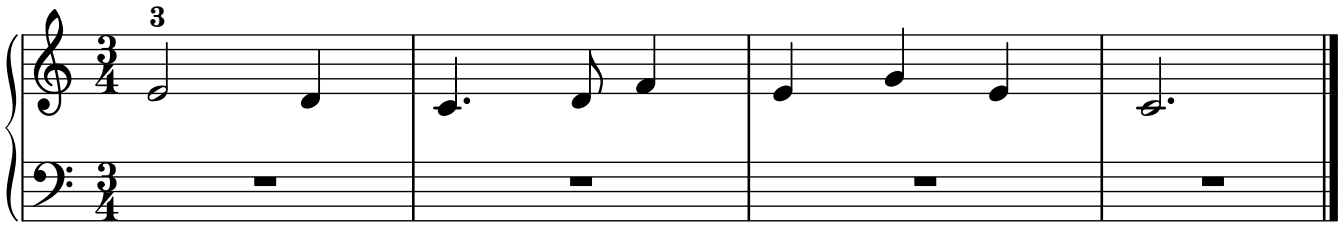


Part C: Dotted rhythms in 3/4

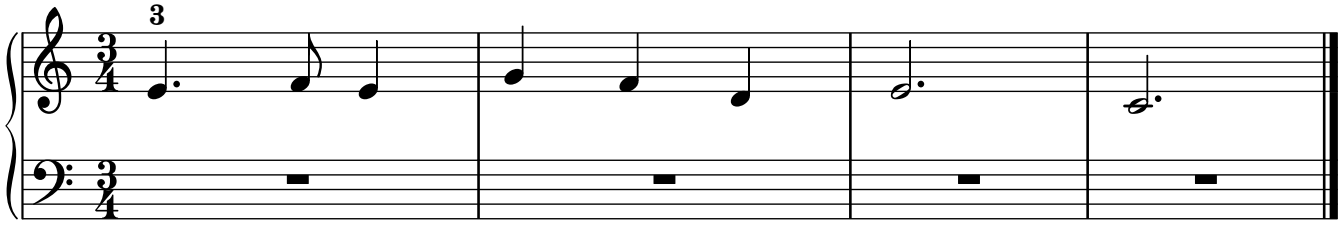
♩ = 72

Dotted rhythms in 3/4.

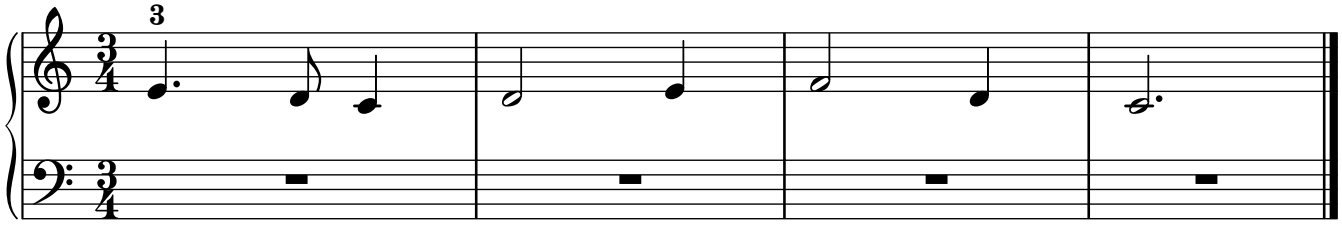
☐ **3.19**



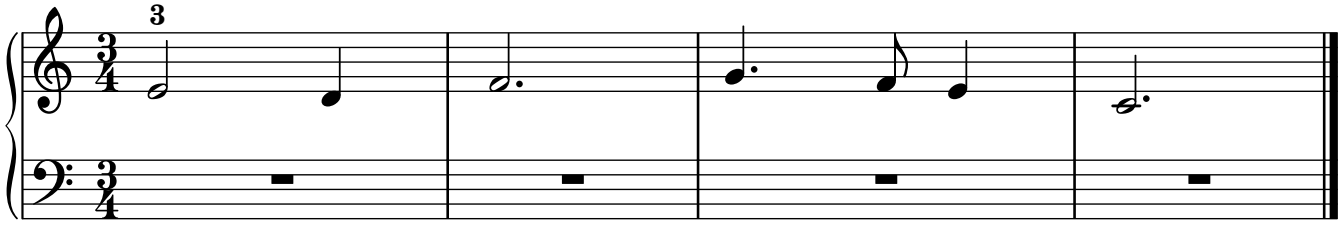
☐ **3.20**



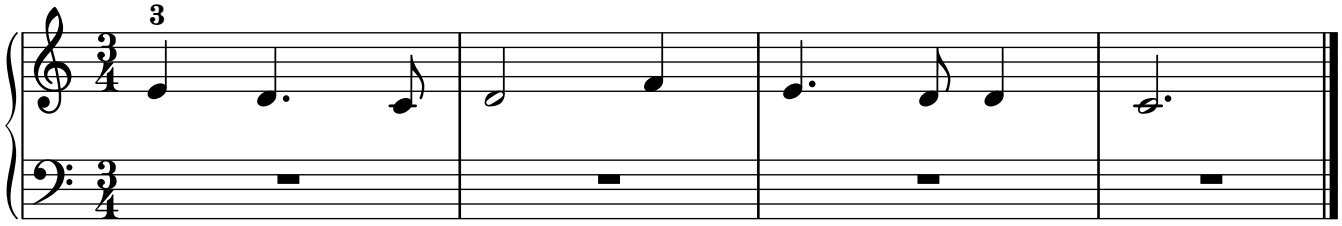
☐ **3.21**



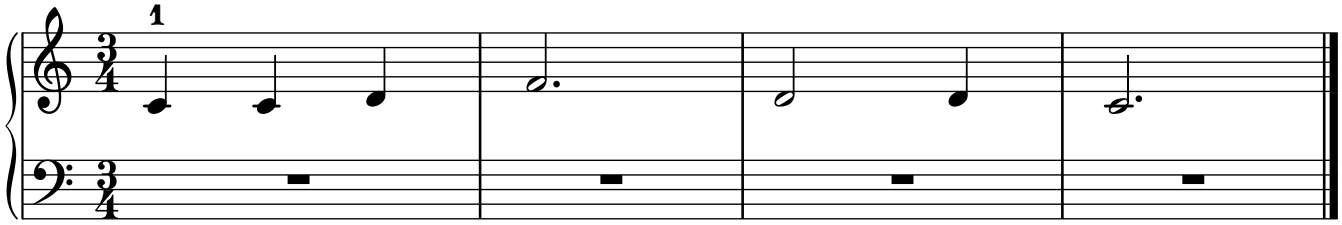
☐ **3.22**



☐ **3.23**
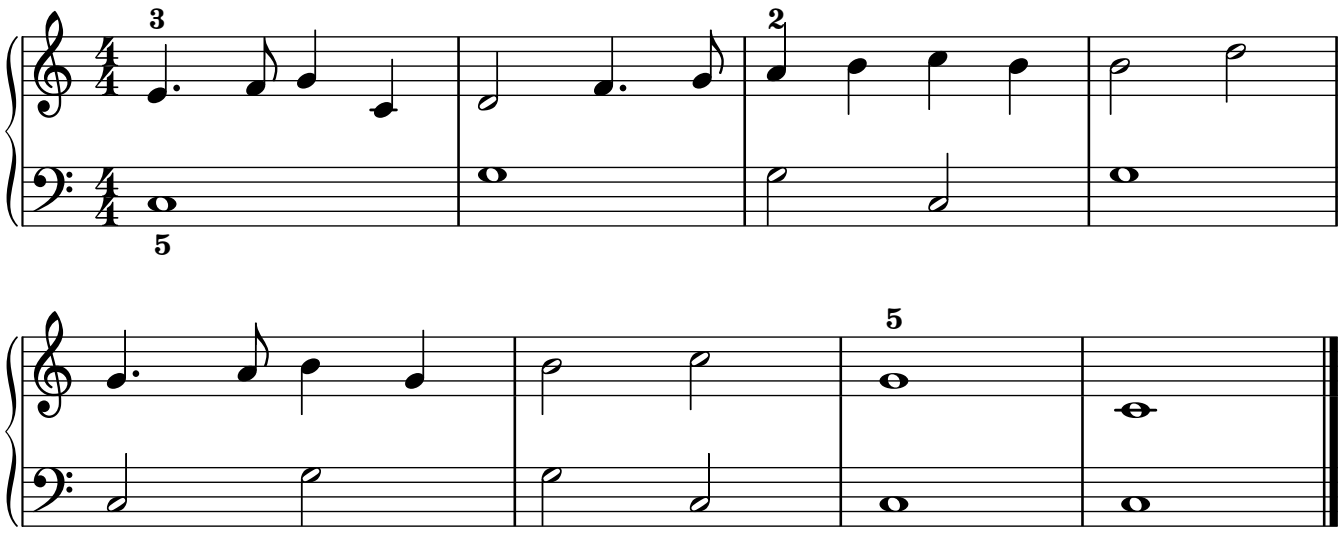


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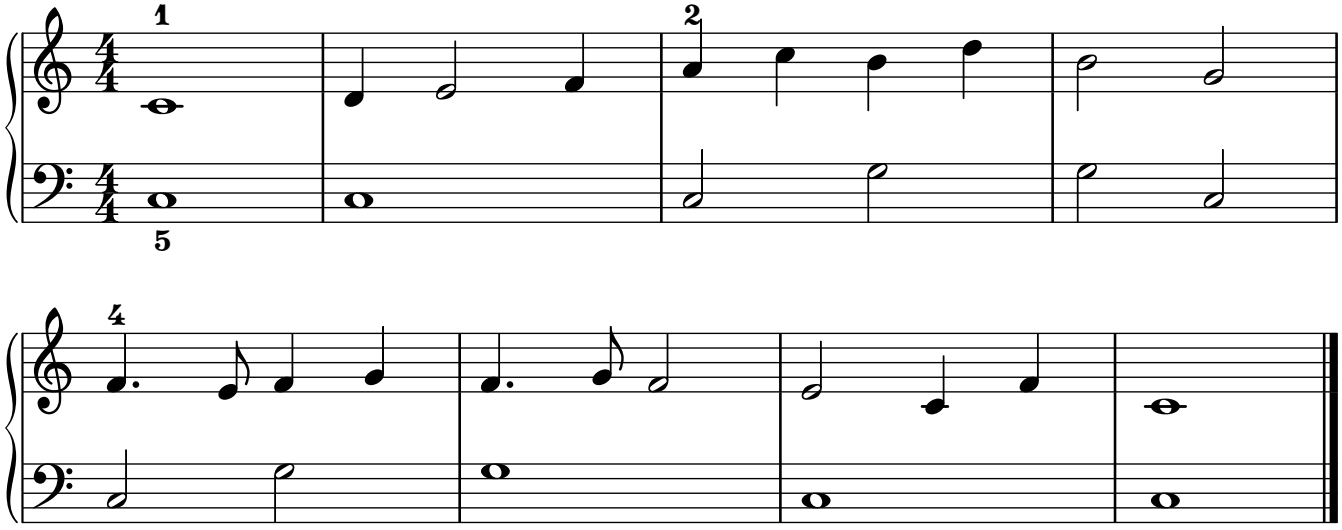
Part D: Hands together, with shifts ♩ = 60

Hands together, with the right hand moving between C and G positions.

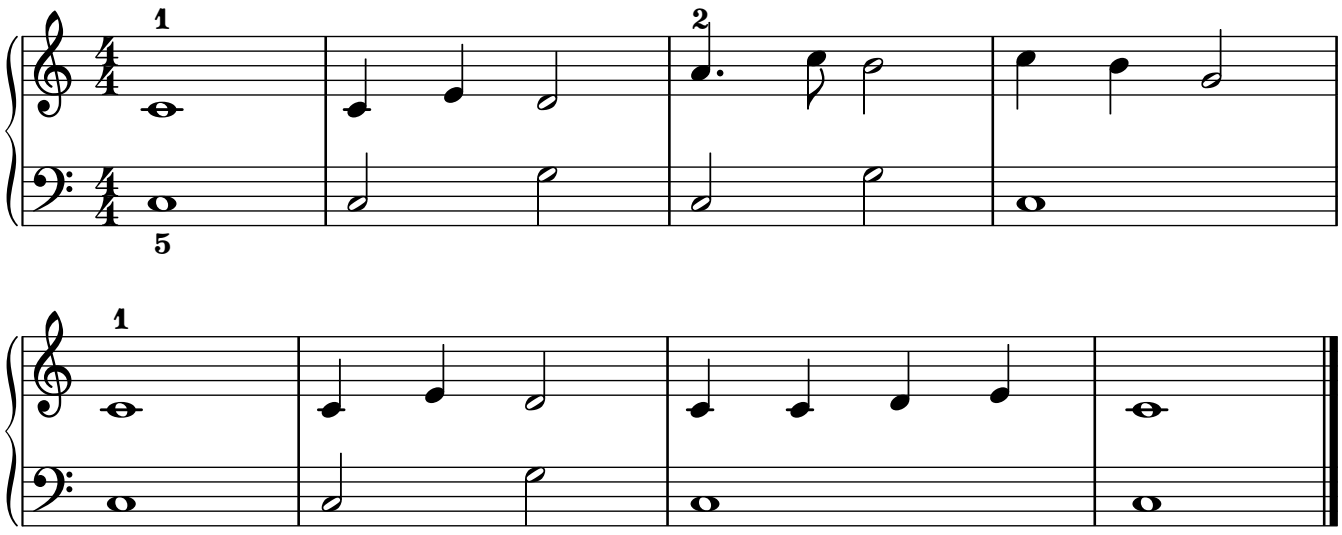
☐ **3.25**
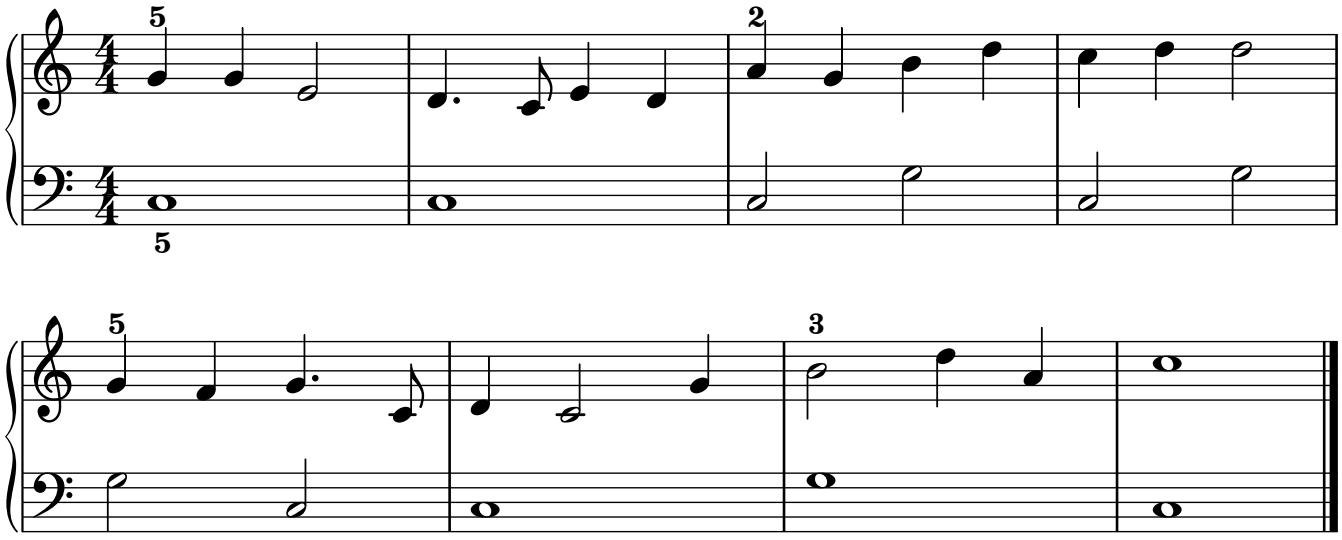


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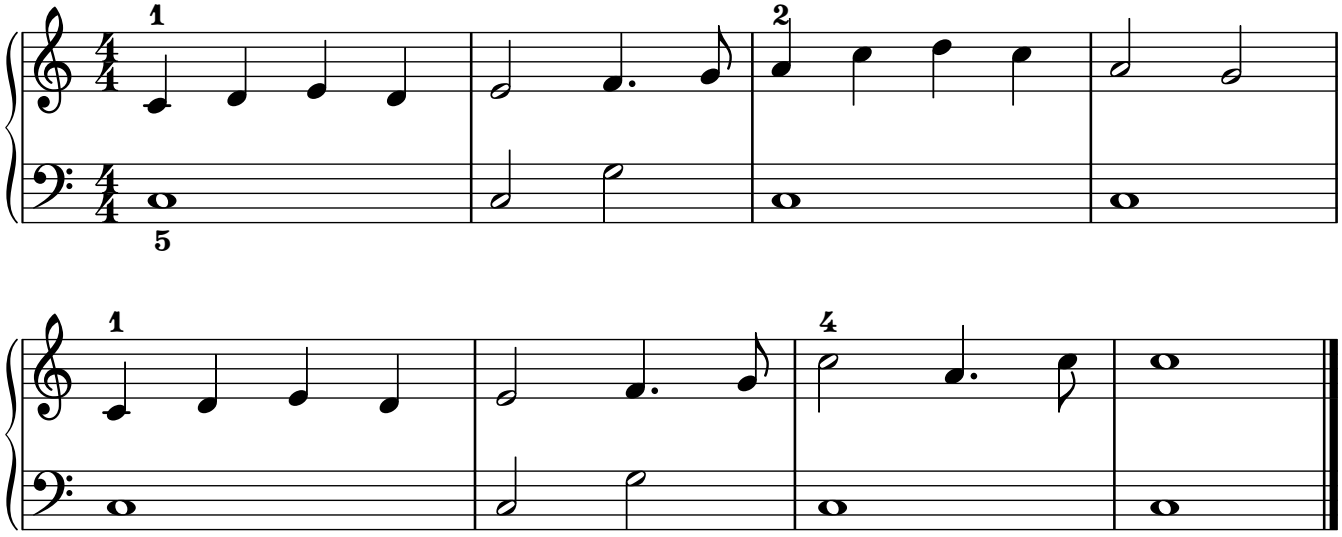


☐ **3.27**
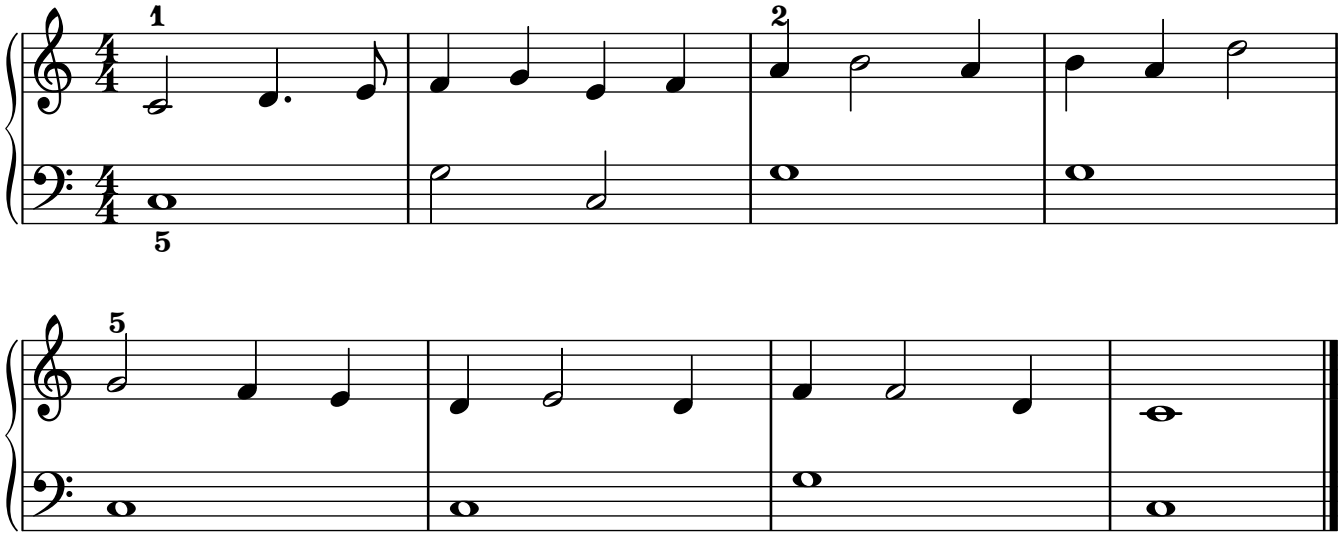


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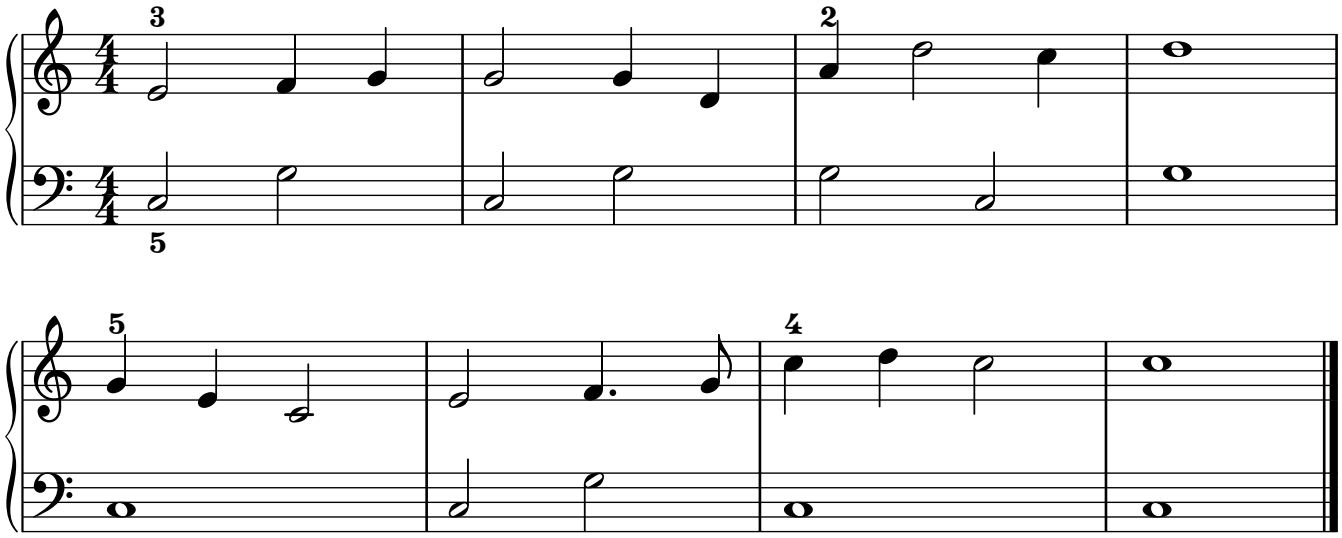


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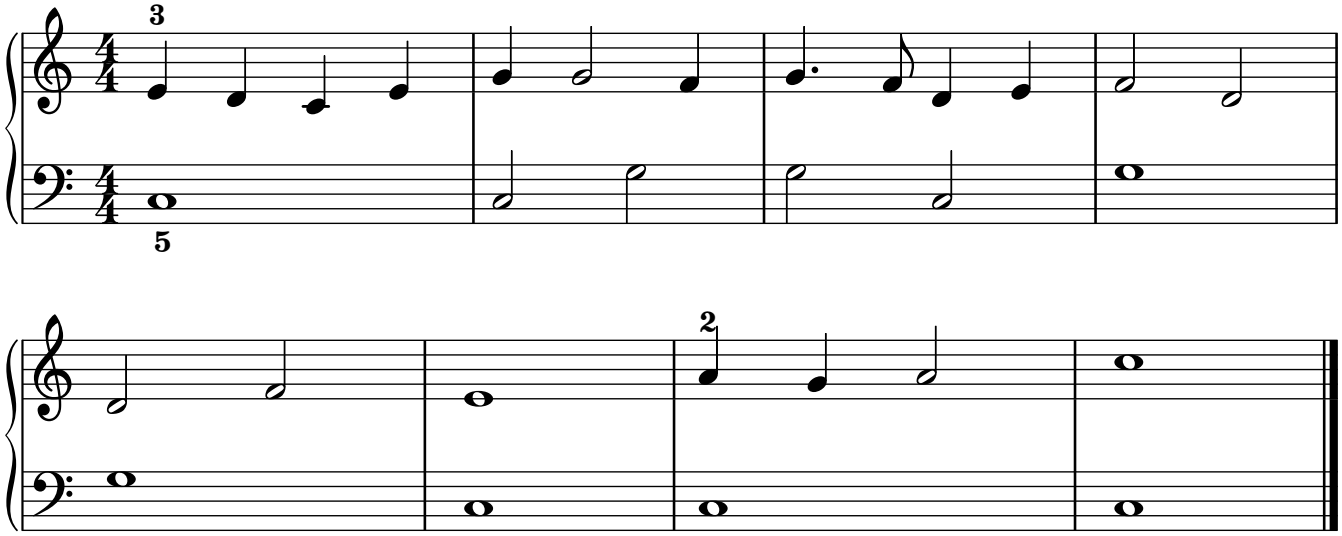


3.30



3.31



3.32
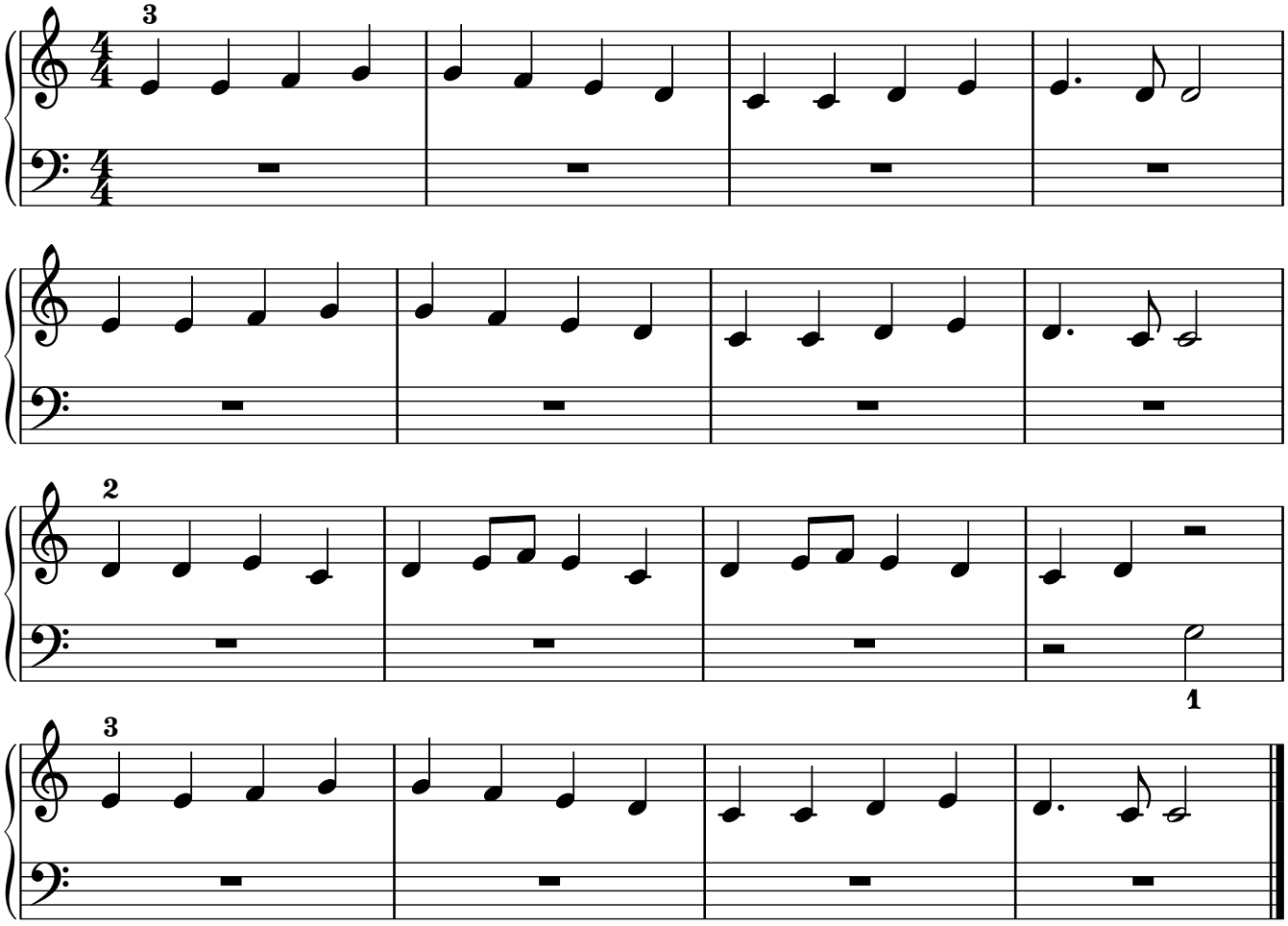


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy (real rhythm) ♩ = 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824)
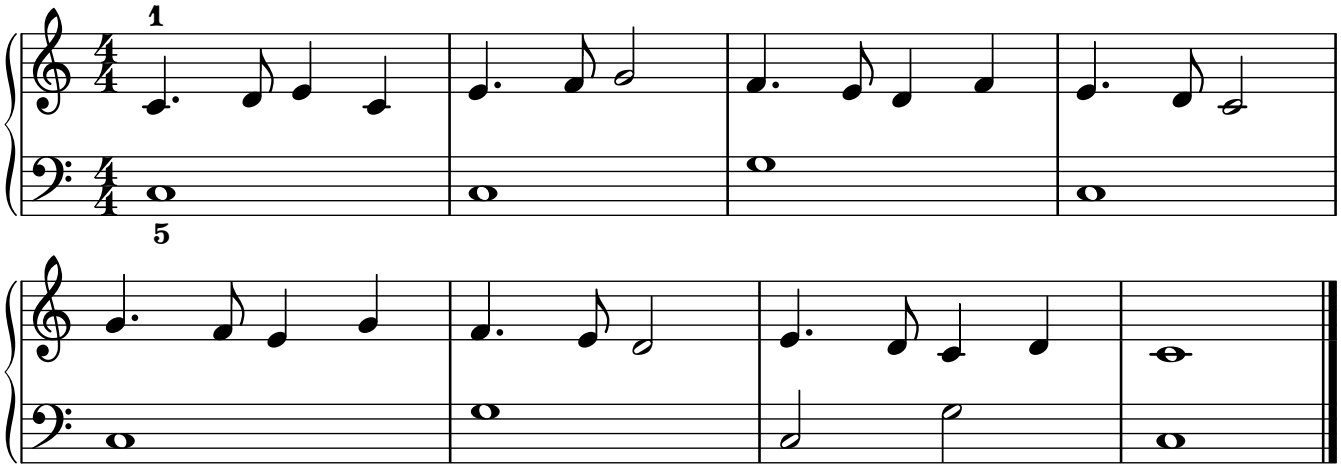
Now in its real rhythm, with the middle section. Bars 4, 8 and 16 have the dotted quarter. In bar 12 the left hand plays the low G with its thumb.



Dotted March ♩ = 76

Original
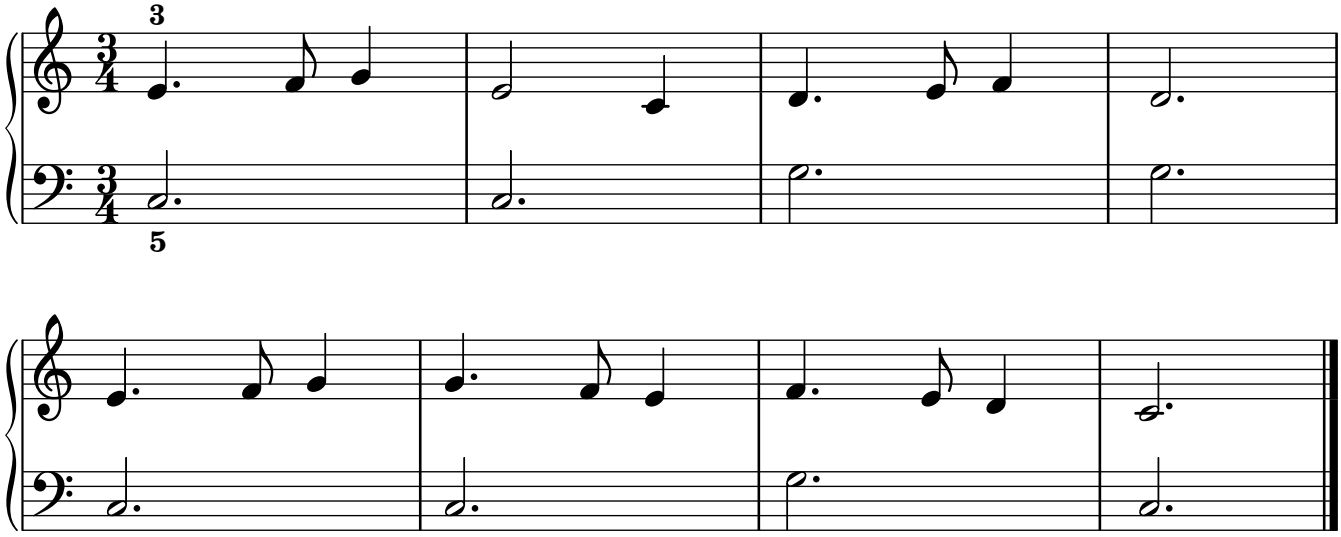
Every bar starts with long-short. March steadily, and give each dotted quarter its full length.



Waltz with a Dot ♩ = 80

Original

In 3/4 the long-short falls on beats 1 and 2. Count '1 and 2 and 3 and'.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play five Part D exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if every dotted quarter is held for its full length and the eighth after it is not rushed.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.